chapter 6 will have you creating functions from functions, and from functions that create functions. In chapter 7 you'll hone your craft, technique, and style. After that comes chapter 8, which leads you right to the heart of CoffeeScript where you'll learn to change the language itself. Finally prepared, in chapter 9 you'll enter the dragon's lair of asynchronous programs.

In part 3 your travels will take you further from home where you'll learn how to build entire applications. This starts in chapter 10 where you'll learn about test-driven development. In chapter 11 you'll learn about building user interfaces for web browsers. In chapter 12 you'll wrap everything up by building and packaging applications, ready for the world to see. Finally, chapter 13 looks at the future and where you, the journeyman, are headed with CoffeeScript.

Prerequisites

This book doesn't assume any knowledge of CoffeeScript. Although some familiarity with JavaScript will make things easier, no level of JavaScript experience is assumed. What *is* assumed is some experience with programming (any language will do) and a basic grasp of web development concepts. Finally, although the Node.js platform is used throughout the book, no prior knowledge of Node.js is assumed.

Code conventions

Any source code listings inline within the text, such as `read 'book'`, are formatted using a `fixed-width font`. Blocks of code are also formatted in a `fixed-width font`, separated from page content:

```
read = (material) ->
  console.log "Reading #{material}"

read 'CoffeeScript in Action'
```